Digital Pathshala
by Aaryaman · AI + digital skills for work

FREE EBOOK · 2026

CHATGPT · IMAGES 2.6 · 4 NOVEMBER 2026

GIFs and the same character, every time

ChatGPT Images 2.6 makes animated GIFs from a prompt or a photo, and lets you save reference images so your mascot, product or pet looks the same in every picture. What's verified, the step-by-step method, 22 exact prompts, and the safety rules.

GIFs
from a text prompt, a photo or a rough sketch

50%
faster image generation, says OpenAI

4 bn+
images created per week across ChatGPT and the API

Facts from OpenAI's announcement as reported by tech press, checked 12 Nov 2026

youtube.com/@DigitalPathshalabyAaryaman

What's new in Images 2.6

OpenAI released ChatGPT Images 2.6 on **4 November 2026**. It's rolling out in ChatGPT and Codex on web, desktop and mobile.

Feature	What it does
GIF creation	Turn a text prompt, an uploaded photo or a rough sketch into an animated, looping GIF. Afterwards, change the playback speed, rework individual frames, and share it
Saved reference images	Keep reference images of yourself, your pets and your characters, and reuse them without uploading again, so characters, products and brand details look the same across a series
Faster, steadier edits	OpenAI says generation is 50% faster, and edits keep character and product details more consistent
Markup edits	Mark the exact spot you want changed (markup already existed in ChatGPT)

Who gets it

Plan	What's reported
Free	Images 2.6 included; limited image creation
Go	More image creation
Plus / Pro	More complex and accurate creation; image generation with Thinking on Plus and Pro; Pro: unlimited, faster

WHAT OPENAI HAS NOT PUBLISHED (AS OF 12 NOV 2026)

GIF limits per plan · maximum GIF length or frames in ChatGPT · where saved references are stored and how to delete them · whether references link to Memory. On launch day the GIF maker was missing from some accounts, so expect a staged rollout.

Sources: DataNorth, 5 Nov 2026; Trending Topics, 5 Nov 2026; eesel AI, 5 Nov 2026 (plan summary citing OpenAI's announcement and system card). OpenAI's own page couldn't be opened during research.

1 Make your first GIF

Prompt → loop → adjust speed → fix a frame → share.

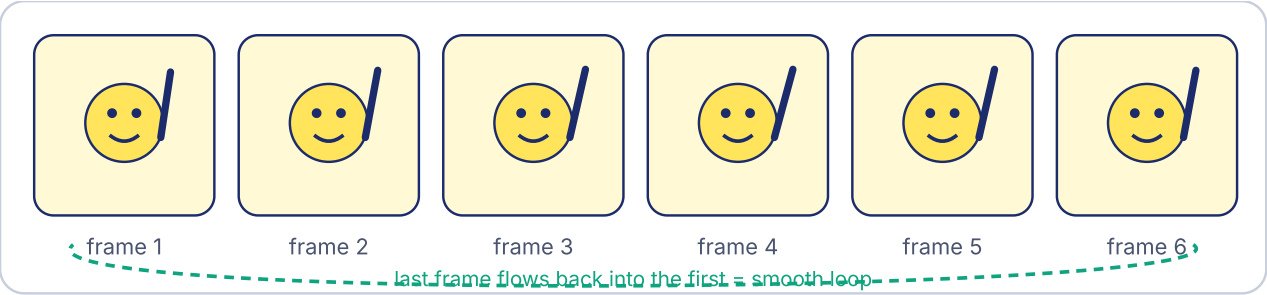


Illustration of the idea, not an actual ChatGPT output.

1. Open ChatGPT and either **describe the animation** or **upload the image** you want to animate.
2. Ask for a **looping GIF** with one simple movement and a fixed camera.
3. When it arrives, **change the playback speed** if it feels too fast or slow.
4. If one part looks wrong, **rework that frame** instead of starting again.
5. Download or share the loop.

The GIF prompt formula

Part	Why	Example words
1 · Subject + style	Sets the look	"a cute yellow round mascot, flat cartoon style"
2 · One motion	Simple movement loops better	"waving its right hand"
3 · Locked scene	Stops flicker between frames	"same camera, background and colours in every frame"
4 · Few frames	Fewer, smaller changes look smoother	"6 frames with small, gradual changes"
5 · Loop + clean	No jump at the end; text often garbles	"last frame flows into the first; no text, logos or borders"

YOUR FIRST GIF

```
Create a looping animated GIF of a cute yellow round mascot in flat
cartoon style, waving its right hand. Use 6 frames with small, gradual
movement. Keep the camera, background (plain white) and colours
identical in every frame. The last frame should flow smoothly into the
first. No text, logos or borders.
```

Steps: DataNorth and Trending Topics (speed, frame rework, sharing). Formula: based on AI Fire's tested guide (6 frames, fixed camera, loop back, no text); frame count is a request, not a documented ChatGPT control.

2 10 GIF prompts, ready to use (1–5)

Fill the brackets and paste.

1 · REACTION GIF

```
Create a looping reaction GIF of a cartoon office worker giving a big thumbs up and smiling. Flat illustration, plain light-blue background. 6 frames, small movements, same camera and colours. No text.
```

2 · PRODUCT TURNTABLE

```
Create a looping GIF of [product, e.g. a steel water bottle] slowly rotating 360° on a white studio surface with soft shadow. 8 frames, smooth even rotation, fixed camera and lighting. No text or logos.
```

3 · DIWALI GREETING

```
Create a looping GIF of a single clay diya on a dark maroon background with its flame gently flickering and a soft warm glow. 6 frames, only the flame and glow move. No text, so I can add my own greeting.
```

4 · LOADING / WAITING ANIMATION

```
Create a looping GIF of three dots bouncing one after another, in teal on a white background, for a 'please wait' screen. 6 frames, smooth, perfectly looping.
```

5 · PHOTO TO GIF (PET)

```
Animate the photo I uploaded: make my dog blink slowly and wag its tail a little. Keep everything else exactly as in the photo — same background, lighting and colours. 6 frames, smooth loop.
```

3 10 GIF prompts, ready to use (6–10)

Plus how to fix a bad loop.

6 · POINTING ARROW FOR TUTORIALS

```
Create a looping GIF of a bold yellow arrow pointing right and gently moving forward and back, on a transparent-looking plain white background, for use in a tutorial. 6 frames, smooth loop. No text.
```

7 · BEFORE → AFTER

```
Create a looping GIF that slowly wipes from a messy cluttered desk (left) to a clean organised desk (right) and back. Same camera angle and lighting throughout. 8 frames. No text.
```

8 · WEATHER / STATUS ICON

```
Create a looping GIF icon of a sun slowly rotating with rays gently pulsing, flat style, yellow on white. 6 frames, smooth loop. Simple enough to use at small size.
```

9 · SKETCH TO ANIMATION

```
Turn the sketch I uploaded into a clean flat cartoon and animate it: [describe the one motion]. Keep the drawing's shapes and proportions. 6 frames, smooth loop, no text.
```

10 · SUBSCRIBE-BUTTON STYLE PULSE

```
Create a looping GIF of a red rounded button with a white bell icon that gently pulses bigger and smaller, on a white background. 6 frames, smooth loop. No words on the button.
```

If the loop jumps or wobbles

FIX PROMPT

```
The loop jumps at the end and the background changes between frames.
Regenerate with 6 frames, smaller changes between each frame, the exact
same background and camera in every frame, and make the last frame lead
smoothly into the first.
```

AI Fire found a 10-frame test moved unevenly and jumped back to the first frame; starting with 6 frames and one small movement fixed it.

4 Saved reference images

Make it once. Reuse it in every image.

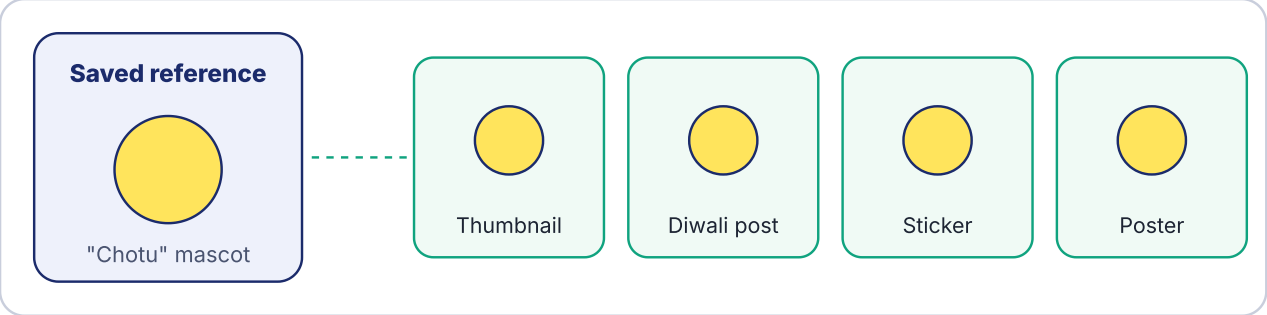


Illustration of the idea, not an actual ChatGPT output.

OpenAI says you can keep reference images of **yourself, your pets and your characters** and reuse them without uploading again. The goal is that characters, products and brand details look the same across a series — the thing creators have asked for most.

The 4-step consistency workflow

1. **Make a clean reference.** One character (or product) on a plain background, front view, good light. Use the character-sheet prompt on the next page.
2. **Approve it, then save it with a name** (for example "Chotu mascot"), so you can call it later. AI Fire's guide shows asking ChatGPT to save an image under a name.
3. **Call it by name in new prompts** and describe only what changes: the scene, the pose, the season.
4. **Check the details** that usually drift: colours, eye shape, logo position, clothing.

NOT YET DOCUMENTED

OpenAI hasn't said where saved references live in the interface, how to delete them, or whether they connect to Memory. Check your own ChatGPT for a references or library option, and use our *Hidden AI Settings* memory audit to see what's stored.

Sources: DataNorth and Trending Topics (OpenAI's description); eesel AI (OpenAI wording "keep reference images"); AI Fire (naming example).

5 7 reference prompts

From one clean reference to a whole series.

1 · CHARACTER SHEET (MAKE THE REFERENCE)

```
Create a character reference sheet for a friendly mascot called '[name]': [describe — e.g. a round yellow sun with big eyes, small arms, teal sneakers]. Show front, side and back views and 3 expressions (happy, surprised, thinking) on a plain white background, flat cartoon style. Keep proportions and colours identical in every view.
```

2 · SAVE IT

```
Save this image as a reference called '[name] mascot' so I can reuse it in future images.
```

3 · USE IT IN A NEW SCENE

```
Using my saved '[name] mascot' reference, show [name] standing next to a laptop explaining a chart, in the same flat style and colours. Change only the pose and the scene.
```

4 · A THUMBNAIL SERIES

```
Using my saved '[name] mascot' reference, create 3 YouTube-style thumbnail backgrounds (16:9) for videos about Excel, ChatGPT and Canva. Same mascot, same style; leave the left half empty for my title text.
```

5 · PRODUCT REFERENCE

```
Create a clean product reference of [product]: front, 3/4 and back views on white, studio light, accurate colours and label placement. Then save it as '[product] reference'.
```

6 · PRODUCT IN LIFESTYLE SHOTS

```
Using my saved '[product] reference', place the product on an office desk, in a kitchen and in a backpack. Keep the shape, colour and label exactly as in the reference.
```

7 · FESTIVAL SET

```
Using my saved '[name] mascot' reference, create the mascot celebrating Diwali, Holi and Eid in three separate square images, same style. No text.
```

6 Precise edits without ruining the image

Change one thing. Keep everything else.

Images 2.6 keeps character and product details more consistent during edits, and ChatGPT lets you **mark the area** you want changed. Two habits make edits reliable.

SAY WHAT MUST NOT CHANGE

Name the parts to keep: face, colours, logo, background, size.

CHECK THE WHOLE IMAGE AFTER

Edits can affect more than the marked area. AI Fire also found ChatGPT may change image dimensions.

EDIT PATTERN

```
Change only [the thing], e.g. the shirt colour to navy blue.
Keep everything else exactly the same: face, pose, background, lighting,
logo position and image size. Don't add or remove anything.
```

FIX TEXT ON AN IMAGE

```
Remove all text from this image and leave the area clean and matching
the background, so I can add my own text in Canva.
```

ONE ELEMENT SWAP

```
Replace the coffee mug on the desk with a glass of water. Same position,
same size, same lighting. Don't change anything else.
```

Tip: AI images still struggle with exact text and layouts (OpenAI's own API guide says so). Generate without text and add words in Canva or PowerPoint.

Sources: Trending Topics and DataNorth (consistency, markup); AI Fire (markup caution, dimension change); rohitai.com citing OpenAI's API guide (text and layout limits).

7 Safety, consent and privacy

Real faces need real permission.

Topic	What's reported
Provenance	Images carry **C2PA metadata** and Google DeepMind's **SynthID** watermark across ChatGPT, Codex and the API (OpenAI system card, via eesel)
GIF moderation	Extra safeguards for GIFs; the system card says motion-related violations are harder to detect, so some categories are blocked more broadly than for still images
Training	On consumer plans (Free, Go, Plus, Pro), conversations may be used for training unless you opt out (see our *Hidden AI Settings* ebook)
Real people	OpenAI hasn't said what stops someone saving another person's photo as a reference, or whether GIFs of real people get a visible watermark

Our rules for creators

DO

- ✔ Use your own photos, your own mascots and your own products
- ✔ Get clear consent before animating anyone else's face
- ✔ Label AI-made images and GIFs in posts
- ✔ Use a business workspace for client or staff photos

DON'T

- ✔ Animate photos of colleagues, customers or public figures without consent
- ✔ Recreate famous characters, logos or celebrities
- ✔ Make GIFs that could pass as real news footage
- ✔ Upload ID cards, children's photos or private documents

India: a photo of an identifiable person is their personal data. Your own photos for personal use fall under the DPDP Act's personal-purpose exclusion; other people's photos used for work don't (see our *PDF to Excel* ebook for the DPDP summary).

Sources: eesel AI (system card: C2PA, SynthID, GIF moderation); DataNorth and Trending Topics (open questions, consumer training note); DPDP Act 2023, Section 3.

Troubleshooting and your first week

Problem	Try this
No GIF option, or it makes a still image	Staged rollout: ask clearly for "a looping animated GIF"; update the app; try web
The loop jumps at the end	Ask for 6 frames, smaller changes, last frame flowing into the first
Background flickers	"Identical background, camera and colours in every frame"
The character changes between images	Make a character sheet, save it as a named reference, describe only what changes
Text is misspelled	Generate with no text; add text in Canva
Edit changed other parts	Say what must stay the same; check the whole image and its size
Hit a limit	Free and Go have lower image limits; wait, or upgrade if you need more

Check these in your own account (before you publish a video)

- ✔ Where saved references appear, and how to rename or delete one
- ✔ How playback speed and frame editing look on mobile vs web
- ✔ How many GIFs your plan allows in a day

Your first week

Day	Try
1	Your first GIF (page 3), then change its speed
2	Animate one of your own photos (prompt 5)
3	Make a mascot character sheet and save it as a reference
4	Use the reference in 3 new scenes
5	A product turntable GIF for a real product
6	A thumbnail series with the same mascot
7	One precise edit using the edit pattern

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Also free: *Ask ChatGPT for a Tool (Intelligent UI) · Claude Sheets & Whiteboards · Hidden AI Settings · 10 Hidden AI Mistakes*

Sources (checked 12 Nov 2026)

Topic	Source
Launch, GIFs, references	DataNorth, "ChatGPT Images 2.6 by OpenAI: GIFs and reference images", 5 Nov 2026
Features, OpenAI quotes	Trending Topics, "ChatGPT Images 2.6: OpenAI adds GIFs", 5 Nov 2026
Plans, safety, system card	eesel AI, "ChatGPT Images 2.6: GIFs, API models, and real per-image cost", 5 Nov 2026
GIF method, markup	AI Fire, "ChatGPT Images 2.6 best features: GIFs and settings guide"
Limits	rohitai.com, "ChatGPT Images GIF creation and editing limits" (cites OpenAI's API guide)
India data law	DPDP Act 2023, Section 3

OpenAI's own announcement page couldn't be opened during research; facts come from tech press quoting it. Illustrations are drawings, not real outputs. Share freely with credit to Digital Pathshala.